

KSA Office IT Support & Infrastructure Management

Phase 07: IT Support Operations

Afaq Business Solutions Co.

Remote Support SOP

1. Purpose

Controlled procedure for investigating Linux remote-access issues using SSH and secure file transfer.

2. Workflow

- Document the incident and create the support ticket.
- Identify the SSH service available on the workstation.
- Check SSH service status with `systemctl`.
- Review recent SSH logs with `journalctl`.
- Test authorized SSH connectivity to the controlled workstation.
- Verify the remote session.
- Test SCP/SFTP with a non-sensitive test file.
- Verify transfer and clean up temporary files.
- Document findings and resolution.
- Close the ticket after successful verification.

3. Key Commands

- `systemctl list-units --type=service | grep -E 'ssh|sshd'`
- `systemctl status ssh --no-pager`
- `journalctl -u ssh -n 20 --no-pager`
- `ssh "$USER"@localhost`
- `scp Evidence/remote_test.txt "$USER"@localhost:/tmp/`
- `ssh "$USER"@localhost 'cat /tmp/remote_test.txt'`
- `ssh "$USER"@localhost 'rm -f /tmp/remote_test.txt'`

4. Security Controls

- Use only authorized hosts and accounts.
- Do not expose passwords, private keys, tokens, or sensitive files.

- Use a controlled non-sensitive test file.
- Verify host identity before accepting a new SSH host key.
- Do not weaken SSH security settings to make the exercise work.

5. Verification

- Confirm the SSH service is operational.
- Confirm an authorized remote session can be established.
- Confirm secure file transfer succeeds.
- Confirm the transferred test file can be retrieved.
- Clean up temporary files and document the outcome.

6. Escalation

Escalate authentication, host-key, network, firewall, account, service, or authorization issues requiring changes outside approved support scope.